TOPIC 03 · INTERACTIVE DASHBOARDS WITH COPILOT, SKILLS AND RULES
LAB 7 THEME · INTERACTIVE DASHBOARD

Lab 7 — Build an Interactive Recruitment Dashboard with Rules and Skills

Maps to	LO3: combine a .Rules sheet, Plan mode and the chart-design and theme-design skills to build a highly visual recruitment dashboard with KPI cards, PivotCharts, slicers and a timeline, and verify every KPI
Duration	50 minutes
Tools	Excel · Copilot (Plan, Allow editing, Chat only) · .Rules · @chart-design · @theme-design · PivotCharts, slicers, timeline
Mock data	data/BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx
Lab files	rules-template.txt (the .Rules text to paste into column A)
Course	Microsoft 365 Copilot for Excel (C34) · v3.2
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C34-Microsoft-365-Copilot-for-Excel/prompts/#lab-7

Goal

Deliver a one-page H1 2026 recruitment dashboard that looks professional, responds to slicers and a timeline, and agrees with independent checks.

What You Will Do

BrightPath's Head of Recruitment wants one page that shows H1 2026 applications, hires, offer acceptance, time to hire, cost per hire and hires against target, and can be filtered by sector, source, recruiter and date. You will put the KPI definitions, layout and colours in a .Rules sheet, so the build prompt stays short. Copilot plans the dashboard in Plan mode, builds it, then @chart-design and @theme-design make it look professional. Finally you prove that every KPI, slicer and the timeline give the right numbers.

What You Will Build

BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx with a .Rules sheet, a Checks sheet, PivotTables on Dash_Data and a Dashboard sheet with six formula-driven KPI cards (one with traffic-light colours), four PivotCharts, Sector, Source and Recruiter slicers and a Hire_Date timeline

Prerequisites

- Topic 2 completed: you can write .Rules and call skills with @.
- This lab folder's data workbook and rules-template.txt.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional BrightPath data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real employees' personal data into Copilot, rules or skills.

Steps

Step 1. Copy BrightPath_Recruitment_Dashboard_Data.xlsx from this lab's data folder into a work-c34 folder on your computer and open it in Excel for Microsoft 365 (desktop). Work on this local copy - no OneDrive upload is needed. Check that Formulas > Calculation Options is Automatic, then open Copilot from the Copilot button on the Home tab or the floating Copilot icon at the bottom right. Read the About_This_Data sheet before you prompt. Read the KPI definitions on About_This_Data - they go into the rules next.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Tables : tblApps (600 applications, Jan-Jun 2026) | tblTargets (monthly hire targets)
KPI definitions:
  Applications = number of rows
  Hires = Furthest_Stage = "Hired", by Hire_Date month
  Offer acceptance rate = accepted / (accepted + declined) (Pending excluded)
  Avg time to hire = average Time_to_Hire_Days of hires
  Cost per hire = total Sourcing_Cost / hires
```

Step 2. Write the dashboard's rules first. Select + (Add work content) > Create workbook rules, then replace the suggested rules with BrightPath's: paste rules-template.txt into .Rules!A1, or send the prompt below. From now on every prompt in this workbook follows these definitions, the layout and the colours.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ALLOW EDITING:
On the .Rules sheet, replace everything in column A with these rules, one per cell from A1
down.
Keep each ## heading in its own cell. Do not change any other sheet.
## DASHBOARD STANDARDS
This workbook builds BrightPath's H1 2026 recruitment dashboard. Never change tblApps or
tblTargets.
Applications = rows of tblApps. Hires = Furthest_Stage "Hired", counted by Hire_Date month.
Offer acceptance rate = accepted / (accepted + declined). Pending offers are excluded.
Avg time to hire = average Time_to_Hire_Days of hires. Cost per hire = total Sourcing_Cost /
hires.
KPI cards are formulas linked to the PivotTables (GETPIVOTDATA) so they respond to slicers -
never typed numbers.
## LAYOUT
Dashboard sheet: title in A1, "Data as at 2026-06-30" in A2, KPI cards in row 4, charts in a
grid below, slicers and the timeline on the right.
Put every PivotTable on a sheet named Dash_Data.
Never merge cells. Hide gridlines on the Dashboard sheet.
## VISUAL STYLE
Colours: navy #1F4E79 for hires, teal #2A9D8F for targets and comparisons, amber #F4A261 for
warnings.
Every chart title states the finding, e.g. Technology led H1 hiring.
Money as S$ with no decimals, except Cost per hire with 2 decimals. Rates as % with 1 decimal.
Days with 1 decimal.
```

Step 3. Build the independent checks before the dashboard. These are the numbers the KPI cards must match.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHECK (Allow editing):
Create a sheet named Checks. Enter these labels and formulas exactly as written, then tell me
each result:
A1 Applications B1 =ROWS(tblApps[Application_ID])
A2 Hires B2 =COUNTIFS(tblApps[Furthest_Stage],"Hired")
A3 Offer acceptance B3 =COUNTIFS(tblApps[Offer_Accepted],"Yes")/(COUNTIFS(tblApps[Offer_Accep
ted],"Yes")+COUNTIFS(tblApps[Offer_Accepted],"No"))
A4 Avg time to hire B4 =AVERAGEIFS(tblApps[Time_to_Hire_Days],tblApps[Furthest_Stage],"Hired")
A5 Cost per hire B5 =SUM(tblApps[Sourcing_Cost])/B2
A6 Hires vs target B6 =B2/SUM(tblTargets[Hire_Target])
```

Step 4. Switch to Plan mode and send the brief. Because the rules hold the definitions, layout and colours, the brief only says what to show. Read the plan: does it exclude Pending offers, count hires by Hire_Date month and put PivotTables on Dash_Data? Reply with corrections until it does, then approve it. Watch the steps, and select Done when Copilot finishes.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
PLAN MODE:
Build a one-page, highly visual H1 2026 recruitment dashboard on the Dashboard sheet for
BrightPath's Head of Recruitment, following the workbook rules.
KPI cards: Applications, Hires, Offer acceptance rate, Avg time to hire, Cost per hire, Hires
vs target %.
Charts: hires by Hire_Date month vs Hire_Target (columns + line); hires by Sector (bar,
sorted); applications by Source (bar, sorted); hires by Recruiter (column).
Interactivity: slicers for Sector, Source and Recruiter and a timeline on Hire_Date, connected
to every PivotTable.
```

Step 5. Make it visual with skills, one prompt at a time, and keep or undo each change. @chart-design polishes every chart; the traffic-light rule makes the target card readable at a glance; @theme-design pulls the page together while keeping the rule colours.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ALLOW EDITING:
@chart-design Review every chart on the Dashboard: titles that state the finding, axis titles,
data labels where they help, and the colours in the workbook rules.

FOLLOW-UP:
Colour the Hires vs target % card green at 100% or more, amber from 90% to 99.9% and red below
90%.

FOLLOW-UP:
@theme-design Apply a clean, modern theme to the Dashboard that keeps the colours in the
workbook rules.
```

Step 6. Verify. With no slicer or timeline selection, ask Copilot to compare each card with the Checks sheet and show the card formulas. Fix any difference with a targeted prompt - the most common error is including Pending offers.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHAT ONLY:
Compare each KPI card on the Dashboard with Checks!B1:B6, with no slicer selected. Show each
card's formula, its value, the Checks value and whether they match.

ALLOW EDITING (if needed):
The Offer acceptance rate card must exclude Offer_Accepted = "Pending", as the workbook rules
say.
Fix the card formula.
```

Step 7. Test the interactivity. Set the Sector slicer to Technology and read the cards, then clear it. Then select April to June 2026 on the Hire_Date timeline and read the Hires card, then clear it. Ask Copilot to add the checks and compare.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHECK (Allow editing):
On the Checks sheet, add these formulas in D1:D3 with labels in C1:C3, and tell me if they
match the cards when Sector = Technology, and the Hires card when the timeline shows Apr-Jun
2026:
=COUNTIFS(tblApps[Sector],"Technology")
=COUNTIFS(tblApps[Sector],"Technology",tblApps[Furthest_Stage],"Hired")
=COUNTIFS(tblApps[Hire_Date],">="&DATE(2026,4,1),tblApps[Hire_Date],"<="&DATE(2026,6,30))

If a KPI card does not change, ask: "Link the KPI cards to the PivotTables with GETPIVOTDATA
so they respond to the slicers and timeline."
```

Step 8. Ask Copilot (Chat only) to review the dashboard as the Head of Recruitment would, act on the valid points, and log your prompts.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
CHAT ONLY:
Review this dashboard for a Head of Recruitment. What is unclear, missing or potentially
misleading?
Does it follow every rule on the .Rules sheet?

LOG (Allow editing):
Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab. For each one I ran, fill in What Copilot
did and How I verified, and set Decision to Keep. I will tell you any row to change to Revise
or Undo.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Copilot pane (or adapt them). Name the table and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online:
https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C34-Microsoft-365-Copilot-for-Excel/prompts/#lab-7

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Plan	Plan a recruitment dashboard following the workbook rules. Show me the plan first.
2	KPI card	Create a KPI card for Cost per hire linked to the PivotTable with GETPIVOTDATA, formatted as S$.
3	Chart skill	@chart-design Turn the hires-by-month chart into columns for hires and a line for Hire_Target.
4	Timeline	Add a timeline on Hire_Date and connect it to every PivotTable on Dash_Data.
5	Visual cue	Add data bars to the hires-by-recruiter table and traffic-light colours to the target card.
6	Theme skill	@theme-design Apply a modern theme that keeps the colours in the workbook rules.
7	Review	Does this dashboard follow every rule on the .Rules sheet? List any that it breaks.
8	Question	Which recruiter made the most hires in H1 2026, and what was their average time to hire?

Test It

Check	Expected result
Applications and hires	600 applications, 41 hires (no slicer selected)
Offer acceptance rate	78.8% = 41 of 52; 10 pending excluded
Time to hire, cost per hire	27.8 days; S$348.20
Hires vs target (amber)	93.2% = 41 of 44
Slicer: Sector = Technology	124 applications, 5 hires, 42.0 days
Timeline: Apr-Jun 2026	22 hires; no KPI card holds a typed number

Checkpoint

Keep the workbook in work-c34. Lab 8 turns this dashboard recipe into a reusable skill for workforce data.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot builds before you approve the plan.	You were in Allow editing. Select Undo, switch to Plan mode and resubmit.
KPI cards do not change with the slicers or timeline.	Cards built with COUNTIFS on tblApps ignore slicers. Ask Copilot to link them to the PivotTables with GETPIVOTDATA.
The timeline cannot be added.	A timeline needs a date field in a PivotTable. Ask Copilot to make sure Hire_Date is a date column and is in a PivotTable on Dash_Data.
Hires appear in January.	The chart counts by Applied_Month. Ask Copilot to group hires by Hire_Date month, as the rules say.

Challenge

Ask Copilot to add a small 'What changed' panel under the KPI cards with two sentences that use formulas (for example ="Hires: "&Checks!B2&" of "&SUM(tblTargets[Hire_Target])&" target"), so the text updates with the data.

Reflection

Which rule on your .Rules sheet saved you the most prompting, and which visual element makes the dashboard easiest to read?